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Moving On

Stepping Down from the Office of Governor

In February 2012, I gave an interview to the online edition of the *Wall Street Journal*. After covering a vast ground on the global and Indian economic outlook, the last question Alex Fangos of the *WSJ* asked me was: 'You were recently reappointed to another two-year term, running out in September 2013. Would you like to serve another term?' My answer was a curt and crisp 'no'.

I was very clear in my mind that not only did I not want to serve as governor beyond the extended term of September 2013, in the very unlikely event of it being offered, but also that I needed to move on from government service into private life. I joined the IAS barely two months after finishing college and it has been the government all the way since. It is where I learnt, matured and was amply rewarded. After over forty years, I now wanted to live without the crutches of the government.

The Succession Story

I first met Raghuram Rajan when I was finance secretary in the government and he was leading a committee on financial sector reforms appointed by the Planning Commission. We had lunch in my office, of idli and dosa, which my staff had ordered from Saravana Bhavan. We also talked a little bit about financial sector reforms.

The Rajan Committee submitted its report to the government in September 2008, shortly after I moved from North Block to Mint Street. I have already written in an earlier chapter about that meeting with the prime